



"Global Warming",
July 14, 2008

"To reduce global warming, we need to adopt urgent measures to protect our environment or else there will be no escape from nature's fury."

ROHIT KUMAR, *Mumbai*

Green Movement

INDIA TODAY has helped us see a semblance of hope to cope with the inevitable calamities that increase in temperatures may cause. ("Global Warming: What India Should Do", July 14). Global warming is undoubtedly a very serious threat to mankind. Our extravagant ways of living and uncontrolled consumerism are prime culprits for many environmental catastrophes in this world. Though we might not live to see the impact of the damages that we are causing to earth, it is our duty to save and protect our planet.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

The cover story on global warming presents many pragmatic measures in the public domain to make a difference. However, there is little chance of their

implementation as the calamitous consequences of green house emissions have not yet percolated down to the masses. Even the Government has taken a retrograde step by enacting the Tribal/Forest Rights Act—Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006—allowing regularisation rather than eviction of encroached forest land.
Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

The extensive human involvement in every aspect of life poses a threat to nature and its ample resources. A majority of the issues can be resolved if a combined initiative is launched. India should safeguard areas such as agriculture, water resources, and forests should be given priority by the Government. Perhaps, the Government may consider having a dedicated ministry to review the

implementation process. In order to address this issue, a consolidated effort is needed.
RAMACHANDRAN NAIR,
on e-mail

Unfortunately, your cover story ("50 Ways to Make a Difference", July 14) fails to mention organic farming as one of the ways. It is recognised by the Food and Agriculture Organisation as the most sustainable means of agriculture. It not only reduces carbon emission, but also helps conserve water. Very few know that organic produce contains 95 per cent more vitamins and lasts longer.
SURAJ PRAKASH GHULATI,
on e-mail

To make the difference, we can begin with our diet. The University of Chicago has recently published a scientific study showing that a vegetarian diet is the

most effective way to counter global warming.
MAHESH KAPASI, *on e-mail*

We should follow France's traffic model and use bicycles instead of motorcycles and cars. This will reduce fuel consumption, besides keeping air pollution under control and ending congestion on the streets.
V. CHANDRASEKARAN, *on e-mail*

The article to adopt greener lifestyles erroneously mentioned that the US aviation sector accounts for 12 per cent of the US green house gas (GHG) emissions. The US aviation industry represents just 2 per cent of the total GHG emissions and its share in the US transport sector emissions is 11-12 per cent.
AMITABH KHOSLA,
Country Director (India),
International Air Transport
Association
The error is regretted.
Editor